

THE FEEDBACK ANALYSIS

HOW YOU CAN LEARN TO EVALUATE YOUR OWN WORK

What is your greatest strength?

Most people think they know what they're good at, but they're usually wrong. So says Peter F. Drucker, one of the most important management thinkers of the last century. He came up with a simple yet clever technique for getting to know yourself better.

Whenever you have an important decision to make, write down what you expect to happen. After a year, compare your expectation with the actual outcome.

During his lifetime, Drucker continually compared his own expectations with the actual results. He learned to give himself feedback, and over time he began to recognise where and what kind of improvement was needed. Or to put it another way, he worked out where his strengths lay, and where they didn't.

Sounds easy? Calvinist ministers and Jesuit priests used this method as early as the mid-seventeenth century – and, according to some historians, the global impact of both religious orders is at least partially due to their use of feedback analysis, and using this technique to manage themselves.

Knowing what your strengths are is the most important thing an individual can know about himself or herself. *Peter F. Drucker*

